

THE FEEDBACK BOX

DEALING WITH OTHER PEOPLE'S COMPLIMENTS AND CRITICISMS

Feedback is one of the most difficult and sensitive processes in groups. It is easy to hurt people with criticism, but false compliments are also unhelpful. Compliments often make us too complacent, while criticism damages our self-esteem and can lead us to make unwise choices.

The one-dimensional question 'What did you find good, what did you find bad?' is therefore not necessarily helpful. In terms of what can be learned from feedback, it is better to ask yourself 'What can I do with this criticism?' In other words, see what can stay as it is, and what needs to change (but may have been good up till now).

It is not only about working out what has not succeeded, it is also about deciding whether and how to react. The model will help you to categorise the feedback you receive in order to clearly establish a plan of action.

It is also important to ask yourself honestly: 'Which success or failure was in fact due to luck?' Were you the winner of a match because the ball found its way into the net purely by chance? Do you really deserve this compliment?

Pay attention to your thoughts, because they become words.

Pay attention to your words, because they become actions.

Pay attention to your actions, because they become habits.

Pay attention to your habits, because they become your character.

Pay attention to your character, because it is your fate.

From the Talmud

+	'I thought it was good, but it still needs to change!' ADVICE	'I thought it was good, and it can stay as it is in future!' COMPLIMENT	+
-	'I thought it was bad and it has to change!' CRITICISM	'I thought it was bad, but I can live with it!' SUGGESTION	-

Arrange the feedback you have received in the matrix. What advice do you want to follow?
Which criticisms prompt you to take action? Which suggestions can you ignore?